Nevan Shively

St. Louis, MO · 314-410-9201 · nevanshively06@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/nevanshively · Portfolio: coming soon

Visual Effects and Game Development student who builds tools as well as images. Hands-on across editing, compositing, and 3D, with Java and Python programming experience.

Education

Savannah College of Art and Design (SCAD), Savannah, GA — Expected May 2029

B.F.A., Visual Effects · Minor in Game Development, with coursework well beyond the minor · GPA 3.92 · Dean's List

Relevant coursework: 3D modeling and texturing (Maya, Substance), compositing (Nuke), game development, programming principles, visual effects survey.

Honors and Competitions

- **Best of Foundations**, SCAD Foundation Studies — work selected for exhibition, Fall 2025
- **Competitor**, SCAD × Autodesk StoryArc Challenge (Autodesk Flow Studio) — informally ranked 4th by an Autodesk organizer
- **75th of ~764 teams**, International 24-Hour Animation Challenge
- **Participant**, Anthropic AI Game Jam
- **Adobe Certified Professional**, Photoshop

Projects

Custom Coffee Maker — Hardware build · Python, Onshape

- Designed and built a working coffee maker that is in daily use, from CAD through wiring and microcontroller code.
- Wrote the Python control code; used AI-assisted design for most of the CAD, refined in Onshape.

Interactive Pattern and Image Tools — Processing (Java)

- Turned a hand-drawn foundation-studies motif into an interactive program where every tile rotates and every section fills independently.
- Built a filter that converts any uploaded photo into a composition of rectangles.
- Built a mock game loading screen using GIFs and image switching with adjustable settings and minor gameplay.

Team Arcade Game — MakeCode Arcade · Lead programmer

- Led programming on a team game, building mechanics complex enough to push the platform past its intended limits.

Rhythm Game — Solo project · Processing (Java)

- Designed and built a rhythm game inspired by the Orpheus myth, covering game design, gameplay programming, and note charting.

Artist Statement Film — Premiere Pro, After Effects

- Shot, lit, and edited a one-minute self-portrait film with 2D and 2.5D compositing in After Effects and original sound design.

Short Film and Broadcast Production — High school

- Wrote, shot, and edited multiple short films, including a 48 Hour Film Project entry, and produced broadcast segments including an early report on generative AI.

Experience

Programming Mentor — HJV Robotics, Savannah, GA · Sept 2026 – Present

- Mentor student programmers on robot software structure, drive code, and state machines.

3D Product Animator (Freelance) — ThriftyBot · August 2026 – Present

- Planned and produced 3D product animation for a new product launch campaign.

AI Training Contributor — Outlier (remote) · June 2026 – Present

- Evaluated and wrote training data to improve large language model and generative AI outputs.

Machine Builder — 3Sigma Automations · St. Louis, November 2025 – January 2026

- Built and assembled automated industrial machinery.

Programmer — Robotics Team 4256 (high school robotics) · December 2023 – May 2025

- Wrote Java robot code in the command-based framework.

Video Production Volunteer — Church and school · December 2024

- Shot and edited event and promotional video.

Additional: Summer camp staff, May 2025 – July 2025 · Food service, McAlister's Deli, May 2024 – August 2024

Skills

- **Video and compositing:** Premiere Pro (professional), After Effects (intermediate), Nuke (basic)
- **3D:** Maya, Substance 3D Painter, Blender, Unreal Engine (asset import, rendering, environments), ZBrush and 3ds Max (basic)
- **Design:** Photoshop (Adobe Certified), Lightroom
- **Programming:** Java (intermediate), Python (beginner), Processing, C++ (one course), MakeCode
- **AI tools:** Claude and Claude Code, Autodesk Flow Studio, Nuke ML-assisted rotoscoping, LLM evaluation and training data